



Social Media Marketing and Controlling

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1. INTRODUCTION

Social media offers significant opportunities for brands to engage with consumers, convey their message, and be competitive in the market. Therefore, it's fundamental for Waynabox to create a comprehensive social media strategy that aligns with their goals, values, and target audience.

The Company

Waynabox is a Spanish travel company that offers a unique and spontaneous approach to travel. Their concept revolves around surprise trips, where travellers book a package without knowing the specific destination until shortly before departure. The available destinations are Spain, Portugal, UK, France, Italy, Switzerland, Belgium, Netherlands, Germany, and Austria and each country has several designated regions to travel. The idea is to add an element of excitement and adventure to the travel experience by allowing customers to explore new places without the usual planning and decision-making process.

Waynabox positions themselves as flexible, exciting, and affordable, with which customers can experience a flexible trip. They can decide the dates and the type of experience that they want to have, although the destination is unknown until 2 days before departure, offering the "surprise element" to travellers. Lastly, the minimum cost starts from €150 including hotel and flight, granting the customers less financial pressure.

Waynabox's Unique Selling Proposition has a message of "Surprise destination concept" which includes "Wanderlust". Through these travels, people can discover themselves, expand their values by increasing their acceptance of new cultures, and make a meaningful enough trip without meeting common expectations before departure. By adding Wanderlust to the trip, we want to approach it as an experience where people can gain new worth and learning in a freer and more flexible trip.

Target audience

The target audience of Waynabox are people living in Europe, 18 to 30 years old, and who are adventurous and spontaneous rather than planned. This is because customers can't directly select their destination when booking a trip with Waynabox, so it may not be suitable for those who worry about these aspects or plan in advance. Most young people including university students and couples are people who have a strong sense of adventure

and want spontaneous joy, Waynabox's target audience should be young and spontaneous people.

Buyer Personas

@WAYNABOX



BUYER PERSONA #1

PAULA GARCÍA
20 yo
Madrid, Spain
University Student

Traits:
adventurous, active,
spontaneous, flexible

BIO:

- Works on weekends & holidays
- Income: 300€/month
- Social Media daily: Instagram, Tiktok, X, Youtube, Whatsapp

Interests:

- Spending time with friends & family
- Discovering new places / Travel
- Playing sports (hiking & running)
- Going to museums
- Surprises

GOALS:

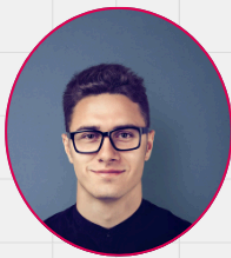
- Travel the world, Graduate soon,
- Before employment she wants to gain a lot of experiences of world as much as possible

PAIN POINTS:

- Doesn't have a lot of money,
- Hates planning,
- Busy life

Favourite Brands:
Vinted / Lime / Bolt / Netflix / Zara / Bershka

@WAYNABOX



BUYER PERSONA #2

LORENZO ROSSI
27 yo
Milan, Italy
IT computer scientist

Traits: independent, disorganized, sportif

BIO:

- In a long-time relationship - 4 years
- Income: 2,000€/month
- Social media daily: Instagram, Facebook, X, Tik Tok, LinkedIn, Whatsapp

Interests:

- Watching sport games
- Hanging out with friends & girlfriend

Favourite Brands:
Apple, Nike, Smart (Mercedes), Zara

GOALS:

- be more romantic
- be more into their trip organisation
- save money for house and marriage in a few year

PAIN POINTS:

- Doesn't know how to organize trips and doesn't like to do it
- His girlfriend pressures him to travel more together(he's busy)
- Doesn't like to spend too much money on trips

By setting the Buyer Persona, we can consider and expect more detailed customers, helping create a better strategy that is targeted to more customers who are interested in Waynabox's travel style. Eventually to make a buyer persona is an efficient way to increase the brand awareness of Waynabox. These two buyer personas depict young individuals with varying financial resources and time constraints. One persona represents budget-conscious students, while the other embodies young professionals who prioritise convenience over

extensive planning. Despite their differences, both personas share characteristics of flexibility and curiosity, making them attracted to Waynabox's user-friendly approach and affordability.

Social Media Platforms

This young target audience is reachable through various social media platforms, with Waynabox currently active on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, and Twitter. The Company aims to refine its social media strategy by increasing the frequency of posts to enhance brand recognition. While Waynabox already collaborates with influencers and travel bloggers, it plans to expand these partnerships to reach a wider audience across Europe. Additionally, Waynabox intends to prioritise user-generated content, which offers genuine insights into customer experiences. This strategy aims to strengthen connections with the audience and make the Waynabox brand more relatable within the European market. Furthermore, the new strategy will incorporate YouTube, with plans to create a company account as the next step. It's essential to note that these social media platforms are highly used by the target audience, as Waynabox shares its message and content, fostering engagement and interaction with its followers (Atske, 2023).

Goals

Waynabox has a primary objective: to enhance brand recognition across Europe within a year. While already established in Spain, Italy, and France, there's room for further growth in these nations and beyond. Our social media strategy aims to boost brand awareness, with success measured by a 10% increase in followers across all platforms. Particularly on Instagram, we aim to gain 30k more followers within the year. Additionally, leveraging website traffic, our target is set at 50k visitors over the course of the year. In terms of newsletters, we anticipate 10k new subscribers. Ultimately, our focus is on attracting new customers, with a goal of 25k new customers by next year 2025, driven by heightened brand awareness. Our main aim is to be the top company people think of when they talk about easy travel. Right now, there isn't one company that stands out for this surprise concept, so there is room for Waynabox to become the first choice for our target audience. We want people to trust us and choose us as their go-to option for hassle-free travel.

2. METHOD - SOCIAL MEDIA STRATEGY

In order to create a successful social media strategy for Waynabox, it is necessary a thorough analysis of our strengths, weaknesses, and challenges faced not only in the market but also within the company, along with a thorough understanding of our competitors.

The biggest challenges Waynabox faces are its customer retention rate (making the customer keep buying with Waynabox), measuring customer expectations and satisfaction, and market acceptance and education of this surprise concept of travelling.

Waynabox's competitors can be divided into direct competitors and indirect competitors among travel agencies and services. Direct competitors include Journee Trips, FlyKube, Kayak, Black Tomato, The Vacation Hunt, and Srprs me. These companies have a surprise travel concept like Waynabox, so their travel reservation structure is similar to but there are also some differences. For example, FlyKube has a more expensive minimum price and they let travellers know their destination at the airport ("FlyKube - the Magic of Surprise Trips," n.d.). Also Black Tomato offers extreme versions of the concept like a trip in big nature, sportif activities (Black Tomato, 2024). For The Vacation Hunt, they have trips that are more focused on honeymoon so their main target audience is also focused on new married couples and family ("The Vacation Hunt," n.d.). On the other hand, Waynabox has a cheaper minimum price than other competitors and has more diverse destinations available to the customers ("Waynabox," n.d.).

Indirect competitors include Skyscanner, eDreams, Google Travel, Trivago, and Booking.com. However, these companies are more well-known, as well as only travel search engines for booking travel products such as accommodation, transportation, and tours, not providing Waynabox's full service. As they have individual sections for travel search, there are more diverse destinations and services that customers can choose by themselves than Waynabox. With Waynabox, all customers have to do is set the travel date and number of people, and all other options are determined for them. However, the difference between indirect competitors and Waynabox is that travellers must collect information about all trips and make decisions themselves.

Content Strategy

In today's travel landscape, Waynabox stands out as a choice for travellers seeking simplicity and affordability in their European adventures. Despite the joys of travel, planning flights, accommodations, and activities can be daunting. Waynabox aims to ease these

burdens by offering a unique surprise destination concept, allowing travellers to focus solely on packing and bringing their passport.

To expand Waynabox's presence and connect with more travellers, a robust social media strategy is essential. This strategy will utilise platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, TikTok, and X to share informative, engaging, and entertaining content. These platforms are the best choice considering our target audience uses them daily (Atske, 2023).

On these platforms, diverse content will be shared. Starting with informative posts that will explain how Waynabox works and guide users through the booking process step by step. Destination highlights will offer travellers insights into potential locations and provide tips for each city. This ensures that Waynabox's support extends beyond trip planning and continues throughout the journey.

Entertaining content, including interviews and behind-the-scenes glimpses of Waynabox staff, will add personality to the brand and engage followers. Additionally, contests and giveaways will encourage audience participation and foster a sense of community.

Influencer marketing will play a significant role in raising awareness of Waynabox. Collaborations with local influencers and travel bloggers will showcase authentic experiences with Waynabox, reaching audiences already interested in travelling. Another important content will be our follower's video, photos and stories: user generated content will be fundamental to show original travel inspirations from those who have already travelled with Waynabox.

Promoted posts and videos will help reach new audiences, while newsletters will maintain contact with interested individuals. These newsletters will offer special discounts and highlight new content on "Waynablog," Waynabox's travel blog providing additional insights into activities, museums, and attractions in various cities. By implementing this comprehensive social media strategy, Waynabox can effectively connect with travellers, enhance brand awareness, and foster a vibrant community of adventure seekers.

For Waynabox's social media strategy, each platform will feature unique content. On Instagram, we'll share photos, carousels, reels, and user-generated content (UGC). Influencer marketing will be managed here, along with reposting Waynabox travellers stories. Stories will include "Call to Actions" with website links, Polls and Q&A sessions for followers. Text will be brief, around 140 characters, and spiced up with emojis for a dynamic

touch. We'll include 10 to 20 relevant hashtags in comments or at the end of posts to boost visibility (Byloli, 2024).

On Facebook, we'll share posts and short videos, focusing on user-generated content and prompting "Call to Actions." Emojis will add flair, and 2 or 3 hashtags will suffice (Singh, 2023).

X platform is vital for engagement. Reposting our content helps us connect with new audiences and expand Waynabox's reach. Posts here will be 20 to 30 characters long, accompanied by 1 or 2 hashtags. User-generated content is key, facilitating easy sharing of thoughts and ideas.

TikTok plays a crucial role in our strategy, leveraging the "For You" page to reach a wide audience. We'll feature user-generated content, influencer marketing, and follow trends to boost brand awareness. Short videos capturing attention within seconds will dominate, with around 120 characters and 10 to 15 hashtags. With TikTok's active user base, we anticipate high engagement rates, driven by easy commenting and reposting ("What Is the FYP on TikTok? | Later Social Media Glossary," n.d.).

Waynabox currently doesn't utilise YouTube, but as part of its plan, it will incorporate the platform. YouTube plays a crucial role in our strategy, allowing us to create longer videos (8 to 15 minutes) that aid in trip organisation and provide destination-specific advice. Longer videos are beneficial, especially for travel bloggers to express themselves fully. Attention-grabbing thumbnails will entice viewers to watch. We'll include 1 or 2 hashtags to enhance visibility (Pant, 2023).

In conclusion, the underlying message in our posts and videos will unveil the essence of the "Wanderlust concept," illustrating the magnificence of travel and its enriching impact on our souls and minds. Through our content, we aim to inspire wanderlust and foster a deeper appreciation for the transformative power of exploration.

Influencer Marketing

In order to achieve the business goals, paid campaigns will be used such as promoted posts/reels, influencer campaigns/collaborations (sponsorship).

Waynabox will be mainly collaborating with local influencers from European countries in order to reach the target audience through the influencer's wider audience. Focusing on influencers with travel and lifestyle content, such as @irisloveunicorns from Portugal, @smibie from Italy, @javicubo from Spain, among others, that relate to the brand's concept.

For this, after contacting the influencer and defining the collaboration together (budgeting, timing, contents), the influencer will have a storytelling approach by posting content already before the trip showing how Waynabox works and, when the trip starts, the influencer will show their location, as well as all the activities they are doing.

By implementing this strategy, the influencer can effectively demonstrate the intricacies of the surprise concept, showcasing its journey from beginning to realisation. Additionally, compiling all their stories into a highlighted folder enables followers to easily access and utilise them for organising their trips with Waynabox.

Every influencer will have their own code to offer a discount to their follower, in this way the collaboration's result will be tracked and controlled to understand if the strategy is having the expected results.

Hashtags are a key tool for Waynabox as they increase engagement and reach the target audience, which, in turn, results in an increase in brand awareness (O'Brien, 2024). Therefore, the hashtags that will be used are related to Waynabox (#waynabox), so regarding its concept (#surprise / #adventure / #experience), travelling (#travel / #travelling / #traveldiaries), and other key words (#friends / #friendship / #specialmemories / #love). As well as seasonal words, to bring more awareness in special occasions (#christmas / #summer / #easter / #valentines #holiday). The hashtag #waynabox makes it simple for potential customers to find all kinds of content related to the company. This includes posts made by the company itself and content shared by users. By using this hashtag, people can easily discover different travel ideas and experiences from other Waynabox users, making it more convenient for them to plan their trips.

Planning and Publishing

The editorial plan plays a crucial role in guiding Waynabox's strategic efforts by defining goals, identifying target audiences, and outlining content strategies. It encompasses various elements, including determining the platforms for content distribution, brainstorming specific topics or ideas for posts, and establishing a structured schedule for posting content. Additionally, the plan incorporates a timeline for tracking progress towards achieving objectives, enabling constant monitoring to ensure that Waynabox remains on course to meet its overarching business goals. This systematic approach not only provides clarity and direction but also facilitates agility and adaptability in responding to evolving market dynamics.

The main topics included in the editorial plan are regarding the possible destinations while using Waynabox (including tips and advises on every destination available); User Generated Content sharing customer's experience and testimonial; Influencer posts to reach more audience; seasonal content showing destinations based on the time of the year and different occasions (Valentine's Day, Christmas, Easter, etc.); informative posts: how to book and travel with Waynabox; giveaways and challenges to increase engagement.

The frequency of posts per platform is also crucial to increase Waynabox's online presence and audience engagement without spamming the audience. Therefore, Waynabox will be posting three to five posts per week on Instagram (Macready & Cohen, 2023), on Facebook two to five weekly posts (Marmer, 2023), three to five weekly videos on TikTok (Macready & Cohen, 2023), on YouTube one long video per week and one post/tweet per day on X (Twitter) (Marmer, 2023).

In this example, it is presented some specific ideas for Waynabox's editorial plan.

EDITORIAL PLAN						
WAYNABOX	INSTAGRAM	FACEBOOK	TIK TOK	YOU TUBE	X	
PER WEEK	2/3 POSTS	1/2 POSTS	3 VIDEOS	1 VIDEO	2/3 TWEETS	
CONTENT	POST: GIVEAWAY TRIP CAROUSEL: WHAT TO DO IN MALLORCA UGC REEL: EXPERIENCE FROM A WAYNER TRAVELLING TO ROME	UGC VIDEO: EXPERIENCE WITH WAYNABOX TIPS FOR TRAVELING IN PORTUGAL	UGC VIDEO: EXPERIENCE /MINI VLOG INFLUENCER: PACK WITH ME FOR A TRIP /BTS SCAVENGER HUNT/ GIVEAWAY TRIP CHALLENGE	TRAVEL VLOG/EXPLORING NEW COUNTRY	MEMES RELATED TO TRAVELLING SPECIAL TIPS	

Waynabox will utilise various social media tools to enhance its online presence. Among these tools are Buffer, which will facilitate scheduling (editorial plan's use) and posting of content while providing valuable analytics insights at an affordable price point. Additionally, Canva will be utilised for its versatility in creating visually appealing graphics, while CapCut will serve for editing engaging video content. These tools were selected for their user-friendly interfaces and efficiency, enabling Waynabox to efficiently create and distribute content across multiple platforms.

Controlling

After the content part, it is fundamental to monitor and control if the company is doing well in executing the strategy to reach the brand awareness goal, which will be measured overall by assessing the ROI (return on investment). The Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) are important benchmarks to evaluate the effectiveness of a social media strategy and achievement of the business objectives, in this case, brand awareness. Therefore, the KPIs that Waynabox will follow are website traffic, which will be measured by the number of website visitors, use of codes (discounts, hashtags) and affiliate links and the newsletter; engagement rate that will be measured by likes, comments, shares, saves on posts; and, lastly, conversion rate which will be measured by the click through rate (CTR) and lead generation.

Continuously tracking these metrics allows Waynabox to gauge the success of its social media efforts and make necessary adjustments to optimise performance and maximise the return on investment. By closely monitoring these Key Performance Indicators, Waynabox can ensure that its social media strategy remains aligned with its overall business objectives and effectively contributes to increasing brand awareness and driving growth.

3. RESULTS (CONCLUSION)

In conclusion, creating an effective social media strategy is essential for brands like Waynabox to thrive in the competitive digital landscape. It is by aligning their objectives with the preferences and behaviours of their target audience, with the optimised use of social media, that Waynabox can achieve its goal to increase brand awareness. However, they need to stay adaptable, continuously refining their strategies to stay relevant and effectively engage with their audience.

Through this essay, we've explored the key components of a successful brand social media strategy, ranging from defining goals and understanding the target audience, to creating a plan for captivating content and measuring its performance.

For the first stage, Waynabox was thoroughly analysed in order to set clear goals, through which it was discovered that their brand awareness was a major weakness that should be set as a main goal. Consequently, other smaller objectives were placed as stepping stones to achieve an increase of brand awareness within one year. Then, their target audience was examined and two buyer personas were created to specify more and develop deeper understanding for the audience. Lastly, the social media platforms were selected based on the existing platforms used by Waynabox and the most used by the target audience.

Subsequently, the social media strategy was created, focusing on the content strategy where topics, formats, hashtags as well as other specifics for each platform were described, explaining with the detail Waynabox's focus on influencer marketing. Finalising with the planning of content through the creation of an editorial plan, choosing the social media tools to be utilised and means of controlling, by setting KPIs and assigned measurements.

By implementing these strategies, Waynabox can draw closer to their goal to increase brand awareness by enhancing its online presence and engagement, and ultimately, achieve its business goals, driving its growth.

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